

Alternative system of GOVERNANCE

Young India swears by democracy but seems to be yearning for a government run by a President

Do you think the President should have more powers than just being a figurehead in India?

Yes	83
No	15
Don't know/ Can't say	2

36 per cent in Delhi and 25 per cent in Indore think that the President should not be given more powers

All figures in per cent.



35% of Mumbai's youth worry about increasing poverty, followed by unemployment (27 per cent) as opposed to terror threats (18 per cent).

Indian youth: a fierce sense of decisiveness.

The looming towers of Indira and Modi in this survey bring out the changing hierarchy in the political cast. There is only one Gandhi who continues to quicken the national pulse and that is Indira. Sonia Gandhi, India's most powerful woman without being in power, is still not the most popular politician. As a leader, the youth may still put her far above Mayawati, but she, at the seventh, is below Vajpayee and Manmohan. And Rahul, who wants more youth representation in the Congress list for the next general elections, is at the sixth, separated from mother by just 1 per cent. The Dynasty doesn't dazzle the youth. The Crown Prince, despite his occasional words of youthful icono-

clasm, is not the Indian youth's favourite politician. He is not the redeemer they have been waiting for. Such a verdict is not good news for a party that cannot think beyond the Family. And it should be heartbreaking for those who project the heir apparent as the brand ambassador of Indian youth. When it comes to political choices, the new generation is least swayed by hereditary mystiques.

The choices are shrinking, and the Congress has no living idols that can make it the party of India's youth. The BJP is not particularly better off. It has only two leaders who are bestsellers among the young. One is too strong and threatening a figure to be immediately—and wholeheartedly—accepted within the party as its official leader of

72% of Ahmedabad's youth say they choose a candidate according to their ideological considerations. Nationally, young Indians judge a candidate on the basis of performance (58 per cent).